

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

1st Session of the 60th Legislature (2025)

HOUSE BILL 1831

By: Hefner, Stinson, and Roe

AS INTRODUCED

An Act relating to community health workers; creating the Oklahoma Community Health Workers Act; defining terms; directing establishment of certificate; making certification voluntary; listing powers of community health worker; requiring and authorizing promulgation of certain rules; directing establishment of certain fees; providing for codification; and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 1280 of Title 59, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

This act shall be known and may be cited as the "Oklahoma Community Health Workers Act".

SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 1280.1 of Title 59, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

As used in the Oklahoma Community Health Workers Act:

1. "Certified community health worker" means a community health worker to whom the State Department of Health has issued a certificate to practice as a certified community health worker in this state;

2. "Community health worker" means a frontline public health worker who has a shared understanding of and is a trusted member of the community being served; and

3. "Department" means the State Department of Health.

SECTION 3. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 1280.2 of Title 59, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. The State Department of Health shall establish a certificate for community health workers. This certification shall be voluntary.

B. A certified community health worker may:

1. Serve as a liaison between health and social services and the community to facilitate access to services and improve the quality and cultural competence of service delivery;

2. Assist in identifying and communicating gaps in current community and health care resources; and

3. Build individual and community capacity by increasing health knowledge and self-sufficiency through a range of activities such as

1 outreach, community education, coaching, mentoring, social support,
2 and advocacy.

3 SECTION 4. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
4 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 1280.3 of Title 59, unless there
5 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

6 A. The State Commissioner of Health shall promulgate rules to:

7 1. Adopt a set of standards for the approval of certified
8 community health workers' initial coursework or curriculum;

9 2. Establish examination administration requirements for the
10 Department or one or more designees;

11 3. Define minimum qualifications for applicants to be
12 certified; and

13 4. Establish the criteria for granting, denying, suspending,
14 and revoking a certificate to protect public health and safety.

15 B. The Commissioner may also promulgate rules necessary for the
16 proper administration and enforcement of the Oklahoma Community
17 Health Workers Act which allow for reciprocity agreements with:

18 1. The Indian Health Service;

19 2. Tribal Contract or Compact Health Centers;

20 3. Urban Indian Health Centers; and

21 4. Tribal health systems.

22 C. The Commissioner shall prescribe fees for the certified
23 community health worker examination, initial certification, and
24 certification renewal.

SECTION 5. This act shall become effective November 1, 2025.

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